

017. Chapter 2 Verses 47

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 2.47

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥ 47 ॥

*karmaṇy-evādhikāras te mā phaleṣhu kadāchana
mā karma-phala-hetur bhūr mā te saṅgo 'stvakarmaṇi*

karmaṇi—in prescribed duties; **eva**—only; **adhikāraḥ**—right; **te**—your; **mā**—not; **phaleṣhu**—in the fruits; **kadāchana**—at any time; **mā**—never; **karma-phala**—results of the activities; **hetuḥ**—cause; **bhūḥ**—be; **mā**—not; **te**—your; **saṅgaḥ**—attachment; **astu**—must be; **akarmaṇi**—in inaction

You have the right to work only, and not to the fruits of work. Let not the fruit of action be your motive, nor let your attachment be to inaction.